

**Responsibility & Control:** *Everything bad happens to me. The man is keeping me down. I am a victim. It's someone else's fault.*

**Life Perception:** *Live today, to hell with tomorrow. Life is too short to plan any further than 30 days out. You can't take it with you! You're only young once! Besides, I'll hit it big someday.*

### THE DISTURBING SIDEWALKING FACTS

While these hypothetical mindposts and their commentary might sound ridiculous, they aren't. Just look at the data. Read the reports. According to a US Census Bureau study conducted in 2000 (before the technology implosion of 2001 and the financial crisis in 2008), here are the disturbing facts:

- A person under the age of 55 is 57% likely to have zero net worth, or negative net worth.
- An estimated 62% of all households in the United States have less than \$100,000 in net worth.
- 89% of all "under 35" households had a net worth less than \$100,000.
- A person in the 35–44 age range has a median net worth of \$13,000 excluding home equity.
- A person in the age 45–54 group has a median net worth of \$23,000, excluding home equity.

In a 2007 Census Bureau survey, 61% of all people who earned income earned less than \$35,000/year. This data unmasks the ugliness behind the Botox injections and the luxury German sedans: Sidewalkers are the majority. An estimated 60% of adults live their lives on the sidewalk. Yes, the world is full of financial illusionists. Once the recent financial crises are factored in, the latest figures will devolve into chilling depths; I estimate that 85% of American families will have zero or negative net worth. But you can bet that they have 650 cable channels streaming into their five flat-screen HDTVs. If you're older than 35 and you have less than \$13,000 in net worth let me be blunt: What you are doing isn't working. You need a new roadmap.

### THE STANDARD SIDEWALKER: INCOME POOR

"Income-Poor" Sidewalkers are the mainstream populous and reflect the lower to middle class. These Sidewalkers work for modest salaries and possess all the toys to show for it, but have little savings and no retirement plan. Their future is mortgaged to the hilt in favor of a lifestyle, with purchase affordability of any extravagance determined by the monthly payment. Every dime is spoken for: car payments, clothes or is sent to stave off the credit reaper.